

System 1 and System 2

1 Two ways of thinking

System 1 is fast, automatic, intuitive. System 2 is slow, effortful, deliberate. Both are useful; both fail.

2 Most work is System 1

An analyst triages most alerts in seconds and investigates a few. Agents look the same: many quick calls, few deep ones.

3 Software has mostly had System 2

General LLMs reason in text: powerful, but slow and costly to use for every small judgement.

4 Route by doubt

Sending the least-sure 20% to System 2 captured 79% of the possible gain; a random 20% captured 3%.

5 Doubt must be honest

Routing only works if System 1 knows when it's unsure. That means calibrated probabilities.

6 When intuition can be trusted

A regular world, lots of practice, quick feedback. SOC triage fits. Novel investigations don't.